M365-01 · Microsoft 365 Service Description & Supported Baseline

What the organization provides, what it does not, and which configurations IT can actually help with. The document every other M365 procedure points back to.

Field	Value
Document ID	M365-01
Version	1.0 · Known Good edition, by Kevin Zelman
Catalogue domain	A. Microsoft 365
Operating tier	Tier 4 — IT Management owns the service description; Tier 1 uses it daily.
Review cycle	Annually, and whenever a service is added or withdrawn.

1. Purpose

This is the reference document. It says what Microsoft 365 services the organization provides, to whom, in what configuration, and where each thing belongs — so that the rest of the catalogue can say "per M365-01" instead of re-explaining.

It exists because a ticket like "App & email access — FAQs from staff" tends to sit past its service target. A set of basic questions ages into a breach when there is nowhere to point. Appendix A is written to be that place.

2. What the organization provides

Service	Employees & staff	Other users (members, volunteers)	Notes
Exchange Online mailbox	Yes	Yes	Governed by M365-02 and your existing email and account policy.
Microsoft Teams	Yes	Yes	Chat, meetings and Teams. M365-07, M365-08.
SharePoint	Yes, through departmental sites	Read access where relevant	Sites are requested, not self-created (M365-10).
OneDrive	Yes	Yes	For drafts and personal working material (M365-12).
Office applications	Desktop and web	Web, and desktop where the licence allows	Per the assigned licence (M365-20).

Service	Employees & staff	Other users (members, volunteers)	Notes
Teams Phone	Where the role requires it	No	M365-09.
Forms and Bookings	Yes	Yes	With the platform limits noted in M365-17.
Power Platform	Limited	No	M365-19.
Copilot / generative AI	Not yet provisioned as an organization service	No	M365-18 governs when it is.

This table is the answer to “does the organization give me X?”, and Tier 1 should be able to read from it directly.

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3. What is supported, and what is tolerated

> **Three tiers of support, stated honestly**
>
> SUPPORTED — IT will help, and will fix it. The configurations below.
>
> TOLERATED — it will probably work, and IT will help on a best-effort basis, but will not spend a long time on it and may ask you to move to a supported configuration.
>
> NOT SUPPORTED — IT cannot help. Not unwillingness; genuinely no ability to diagnose or fix.
>
> Saying which is which is kinder than discovering it during a problem, and it lets Tier 1 answer confidently instead of hedging.

	Supported	Tolerated	Not supported
Mail client	Outlook desktop on an organization device; Outlook on the web; Outlook mobile	Outlook desktop on a compliant personal device	Third-party mail clients; legacy Outlook versions; IMAP/POP
Browser	Current Edge, Chrome, Firefox, Safari	Recent versions of those	Anything unsupported by its own vendor
Device	Organization-owned and compliant (DEV-02)	Personal, under DEV-07	Jailbroken or rooted; shared household computers for CONFIDENTIAL work
Operating system	Currently supported Windows and macOS builds	One version behind	Anything out of vendor support
Teams	Desktop and mobile apps, current version	Teams on the web	Third-party clients
File sync	OneDrive sync client on an organization device	On a compliant personal device	Third-party sync tools against organization storage

4. Where things live

The question behind a surprising share of tickets. One table.

If you want...	Go to
Your email and calendar	Outlook — desktop, web at outlook.office.com, or mobile.
Your own working files and drafts	Your OneDrive.
Your department's shared files	Your department's SharePoint site (M365-12).
A team conversation	Teams.
Staff information and organization news	The staff portal.
IT help, guides and how-to	The knowledge base, or the service desk.
Organization policies and procedures	The policies page on the staff portal.
To reset your password	aka.ms/sspr (ACC-04).
To set up or change your security methods	aka.ms/mysecurityinfo (ACC-03).

5. What the organization does not provide

Stated so that nobody spends time looking for it.

- Personal Microsoft accounts, or personal use of the organization tenant.
- Mailboxes for people without a relationship with the organization. A guest is not a mailbox holder (ACC-10 §5).
- Unlimited retention. Content is retained per policy (M365-16), not forever by default.
- Support for personally-purchased software, whatever it is used for.
- Data recovery from a personally-owned device.
- Copilot or other generative AI as a provisioned organization service, at present (M365-18).

6. Availability and support hours

- The Microsoft 365 service itself is provided by Microsoft with its own availability commitment. IT does not control it and cannot restore it during a Microsoft outage — what IT can do is tell the organization what is happening, which it will.
- IT support hours are per GOV-06 §6, by tier. Those figures need confirming from the Head of IT before this document is published.
- Where Tier 1 coverage reduces during holiday periods, that is published in advance rather than discovered on the day.
- Where a Microsoft service is degraded, IT posts to the knowledge base rather than waiting to be asked. A community that can see the status stops opening tickets about it.

7. Where to go for what

Something is broken	The service desk — the front door for everything technology-related (GOV-02 §3).
You need access to something	The service desk. The owner of the thing approves; IT does the granting (M365-11).
You want to know how to do something	The knowledge base first, then the service desk.
It is not IT's at all	The service desk will route it to the right desk, and that counts as it being dealt with.
You think an account has been compromised	The service desk immediately, saying so explicitly (M365-22).
You have a suggestion about a procedure	Raise it against the document ID through the service desk (GOV-01 §10).

8. Records

Record	Held in	Retention
This service description, as approved	SOP library	Life of the document
Changes to what is provided or supported	Change record (M365-21)	7 years
Published service degradation notices	IT communications record	3 years

9. Related documents

ID	Title	Relationship
Email Policy	Your organization's email and account policy	Governs the mailbox row of §2.
M365-02	Exchange Online Mailbox Standard	The detail behind the mailbox service.
M365-12	OneDrive Appropriate Use	§4 — the OneDrive versus SharePoint question.
M365-20	License Assignment, Reclamation & Cost Attribution	What each licence actually includes.
DEV-02 / DEV-07	Device Compliance / Personal Device	The device rows of §3.
ACC-03 / ACC-04	MFA / Password standards	The §4 self-service addresses.
GOV-02	Service Desk Intake & Ticket Quality	§7.
GOV-06	Service Commitments, Priority & Escalation	Supplies §6.
GOV-05	Knowledge Base Article Standard	Format for publishing Appendix A.

Appendix A — Staff FAQ

Publish this on the knowledge base under GOV-05, and use it to close the FAQ ticket.

Question	Answer
What email do I get?	A full Exchange Online mailbox with an address at your domain, reachable from Outlook on your computer, at outlook.office.com, and on your phone.
Can I read organization email on my own phone?	Yes. We apply protection to the organization apps only — see DEV-07 for exactly what we can and cannot see, which is much less than people assume.
Where should I save my files?	Your own drafts and working notes: OneDrive. Anything your department relies on, or that the organization would need if you left: your department's SharePoint site.
Do I need the VPN?	Almost certainly not. Email, Teams, SharePoint and OneDrive all work from anywhere. The VPN is only for on-premises systems (DEV-10).
I forgot my password	aka.ms/sspr resets it without contacting anyone, provided you have two security methods registered. Registering the second one takes two minutes and is the best five minutes you will spend.
I have a new phone	Set up your security method on the new phone BEFORE you get rid of the old one. Otherwise you will need to verify your identity in person or on video with photo ID.
Which browser should I use?	Current Edge, Chrome, Firefox or Safari. All fine.
Can I use a different mail app?	Outlook is what we support. Others may work, but we will not be able to help much when they do not.
How do I get a shared departmental mailbox?	Ask the service desk. It needs a named owner from your department who approves who can read it (M365-03).
How do I email everyone in a group?	Through the office that owns that population — usually HR or Communications (M365-06).
How do I get a SharePoint site?	Ask the service desk with a named owner, a one-sentence purpose, and who needs access (M365-10).
Something is broken. Who do I ask?	The service desk. If it turns out not to be ours, we will send it to the right desk.
I think somebody else has been in my account	Tell the service desk straight away and say so explicitly. Do not change your password first — we need to see the sign-in trail before it changes.
Will IT ever ask for my password?	Never. Not by email, phone or ticket. Anyone who does is not IT.

Part of the Known Good SOP Catalog by Kevin Zelman, written for small IT shops, contractors and consultants, career-changers and help desk technicians. Adapt the names, tiers and times to your own shop: the times here are cushion, not a promise.